INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: SPIRITS & LIQUEURS

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will learn basics of spirit and liqueur production including the base ingredients, flavors, and location of production for important spirits of the world.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will gain a deeper knowledge in spirits and liqueurs of the world by understand the region, styles, raw materials, aging requirements, and the general production process. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recommend spirits and liqueurs to guests and will know the base spirits, mixers, and garnishes for selected cocktails.

INTRODUCTORY LEVEL - CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM LEVEL INFORMATION IS NOTED IN *RED*

General Category	CLEAR SPIRITS			AGAVE-BASED SPIRITS	
Spirit Category	**Vodka**	**Rum**	**Gin**	**Tequila**	**Mezcal**
Region Of Origin	Anywhere in the world	Can be anywhere but traditionally Caribbean	Anywhere in the world	Jalisco, Mexico	Oaxaca, Mexico
Subregions					
Styles/Age Requirements		Light, Dark, Aged, Spiced	London Dry	**Blanco:** under 2 months **Reposado:** 2 months to 1 year in oak **Añejo:** 1 year to 3 years in oak	Blanco (most common), Reposado, Añejo
Raw Material	Commonly cereal grain but can be anything	Sugarcane and Molasses	Neutral Grain	Blue Agave	Agave (many varieties)
Type of distillation	Commonly continuous still	Continuous or pot still	Continuous	Continuous or pot still	Continuous or pot still
Distinct process	Multiple times in continuous still to remove any flavors		Flavored with botanicals and Juniper berries.		Agave cooked over fire in pits gives a smoky character.
Producers	Tito's, Absolut, Smirnoff, Stolichnaya, Grey Goose, Kettle One, Cîroc, Belvedere	Myers's, Mount Gay, Bacardi, Captain Morgan (Spiced), Diplomático, Goslings, Havana Club	Tanqueray, Bombay, Nolet, Beefeater, Hendrick's, Sipsmith	Don Julio, Jose Cuervo, Patron, Herradura, Sauza, El Jimador, 1800, Hornitos	Bozal, Del Maguey, Wahaka

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INTRODUCTORY LEVEL - CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM LEVEL INFORMATION IS NOTED IN *RED*

General Category	Whisk(e)y					
Spirit Category	**Bourbon**	**Tennessee**	**Canadian Whisky**	**Irish Whiskey**	**Scotch Whisky**	
Region	USA (Most are made in Kentucky but not required)	Tennessee, USA	Canada	Ireland	Scotland	
Subregions					Highland, Lowland, Islay (Smokiest), Speyside, Campbeltown	**Blended Scotch**
Styles/Age Requirements			Min 3 years in oak		Single Malt/Blended	Blended Scotch
Raw Material	51% Corn	51% Corn	Corn, wheat, rye, or barley	Barley	Barley	Barley
Type of distillation			Typically continuous	Three times in pot still	Two times in pot still, Lowlands is three times	Three times in pot still
Distinct process	New, charred, American white oak age	Filtered through maple charcoal			Peat fires dry the barley giving a smoky character	
Producers	Jim Beam, Maker's Mark, Wild Turkey, Bulleit, Buffalo Trace, Woodford Reserve	Jack Daniels, George Dickel	Crown Royal, Pike Creek, Canadian Club	Jameson, Tullamore Dew, Bushmills, Proper Twelve	**Highland/Speyside:** The Glenlivet, Macallan, Singleton, Glenmorangie. **Lowland:** Glenkinchie, Auchentoshan. **Islay:** Lagavulin, Laphroig, Ardbeg, Bowmore, Caol Ila	Johnnie Walker, Ballantine's, Chivas, Grant's, Famous Grouse, J&B, Dewar's

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INTRODUCTORY LEVEL - CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM LEVEL INFORMATION IS NOTED IN *RED*

General Category	BRANDY				
Spirit Category	**Cognac**	**Armagnac**	**Calvados**	**Eaux de Vie de Fruits**	**Pomace Brandy**
Region/Country	Cognac / France	Armagnac / France	Calvados / France	France	**Grappa**: Italy **Marc:** France
Subregions	Grand Champagne, Petite Champagne (Fine Champagne)	Haut Armagnac, Bas Armagnac, Ténerèze			
Styles/Age Requirements	VS/Three Star: 2 years VSOP: 4 years XO: 10 years	VS/Three Star: 2 years VSOP: 4 years XO: 10 years	Min 2 years in oak	Framboise, Kirsch, Poire William	
Raw Material	**White Grapes:** mainly Ugni Blanc	**White Grapes:** Ugni Blanc, Folle Blanche, Colombard, Baco	Apples, Pears	Raspberry, Cherry, Pear	
Type of distillation	Two times in a pot still	One time in a unique continuous still	Two times in a pot still. Some use continuous.		
Distinct process	Aged in French oak	Aged in French oak	Aged in French oak	Generally no aging	Generally no aging
Producers	Hennessey, Rémy Martin, Courvoisier, Martell	Larressingle, Delord, Montal			

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INTRODUCTORY LEVEL - CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM LEVEL INFORMATION IS NOTED IN *RED*

General Category	LIQUEURS AND CORDIALS					
Type	**Herb & Nut**	**Fruit**	**Cream**	**Whiskey**	**Other**	
Producers	Benedictine, B&B, Pimm's, Chartreuse, Crème de Menthe, Frangelico **Anise:** Anisette, Galliano, Ouzo, Sambuca	**Orange:** Triple Sec, Cointreau, Grand Marnier **Apricot:** Amaretto **Peaches:** Southern Comfort	Baileys Irish Cream	Drambuie, Glayva, Irish Mist	**Elderflower:** St. Germain **Ginger:** Canton **Coffee**: Kahlúa, Tia Maria	

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: COCKTAILS

CERTIFIED EXAM ONLY

A CERTIFIED SOMMELIER WILL KNOW THE BASE SPIRITS, MIXERS, AND GARNISHES FOR THE FOLLOWING COCKTAILS

Americano	French 75	Kamikaze	Mojito	Rusty Nail	Vieux Carré
Aviation	French Martini	Kir Royale	Moscow Mule	Sazerac	Whiskey Sour
Caipirinha	Gibson	Mai Tai	Negroni	Sea Breeze	White Russian
Champagne Cocktail	Gimlet	Manhattan	Old Fashioned	Sidecar	
Cosmopolitan	Greyhound	Margarita	Pimm's Cup	Tom Collins	
Daiquiri	John Collins	Mint Julep	Pisco Sour	Vesper	